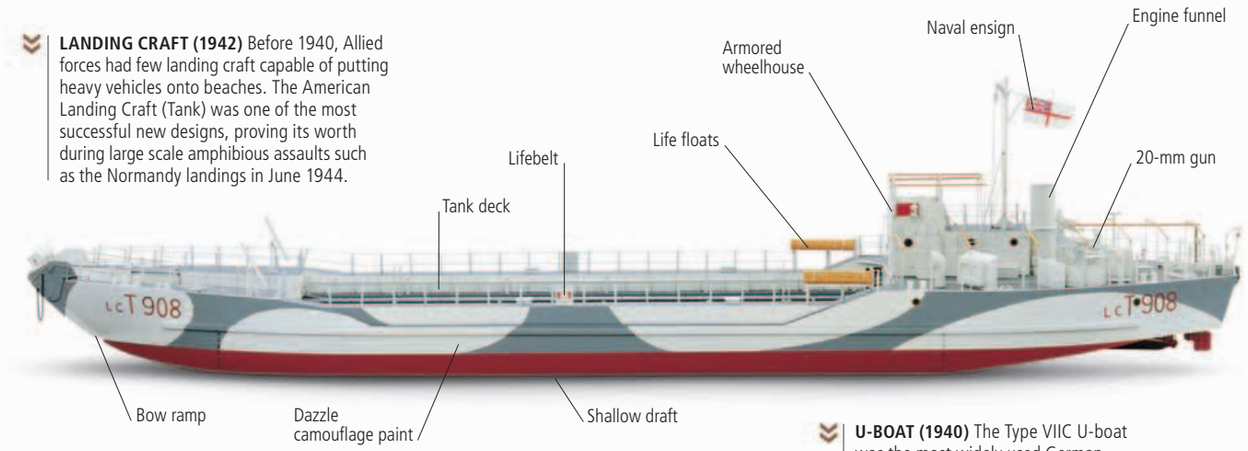
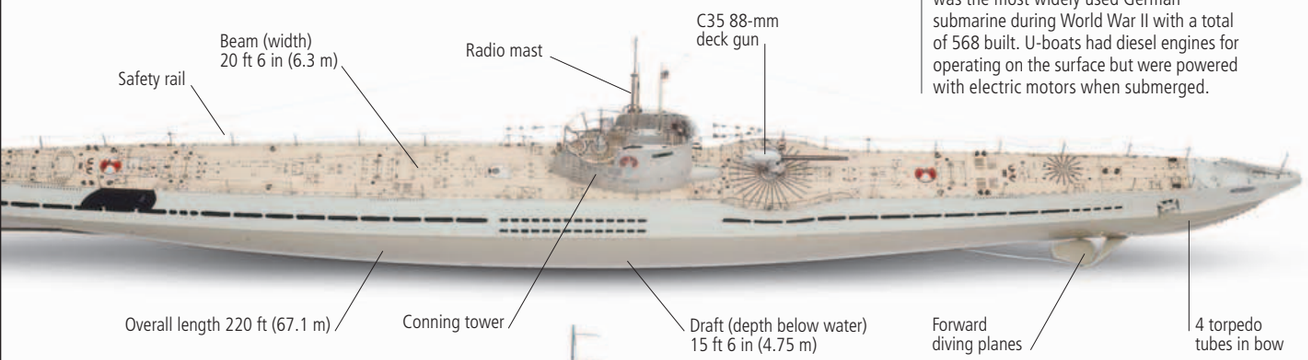
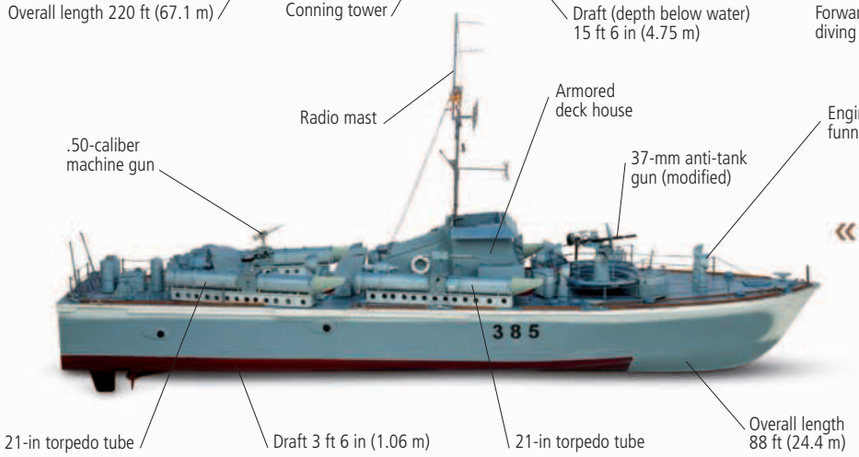


LANDING CRAFT (1942) Before 1940, Allied forces had few landing craft capable of putting heavy vehicles onto beaches. The American Landing Craft (Tank) was one of the most successful new designs, proving its worth during large scale amphibious assaults such as the Normandy landings in June 1944.



U-BOAT (1940) The Type VIIC U-boat was the most widely used German submarine during World War II with a total of 568 built. U-boats had diesel engines for operating on the surface but were powered with electric motors when submerged.



PT BOAT (1942) A variety of motor torpedo boat used by the US Navy in World War II. Small, fast, and armed with several torpedoes, they provided an inexpensive way of attacking large surface ships, even battleships, without requiring heavy naval guns.

GLOSSARY

PORT The left side of the ship, looking foreward.
POWER PROJECTION A state's ability to deploy naval and other military forces far from its own territory. This threat of force can be used as a political weapon.
PRIZE REGULATIONS Rules governing the taking of enemy merchant ships as prizes with regard to treatment of prisoners and profits made from the sale of the ship and its cargo.
PRAM Shallow-hulled Swedish sailing ship used as gunboat in naval warfare in the Baltic.
PRE-DREADNOUGHT Battleship built or ordered before HMS *Dreadnought* set new standards for armament, armor, and speed when she was launched in 1906.
PRESS To conscript sailors to serve on a warship.
PROW, GIVING THE Tactic employed in the 16th century of firing first with guns in the bow then delivering a broadside.
PT BOAT Patrol torpedo boat. Small, fast US craft of World War II, usually with four torpedo tubes.
QUARTERDECK The deck at the rear of a sailing ship below the poop, where the ship's wheel and binnacle are located.
QUINQUEREME Large warship of the Hellenic and Roman eras.
Q-SHIP Merchantman with concealed guns used by the British to trick U-boats in World War I.
RAM Projecting armored beak at the front of an Ancient Greek or Roman galley. Ramming was revived as a tactic in 19th century when early ironclads were fitted with reinforced bows for ramming.
RATING Classification of sailing warships according to the number of cannon they carried.
REEF To reduce the area of sail when a strong wind is blowing.
RIGGING All the ropes, etc. that support masts and yards or are used to hoist, lower, or trim sails.
SCREEN To sail ahead of a fleet for reconnaissance and to act as protection for the other ships.
SCUTTLE To sink one's own ship deliberately, often to avoid capture.
SEXTANT Nautical instrument for measuring the angle of the sun or a star to the horizon.

